

Victor Espiritu Santiago

AI & ENTERPRISE ARCHITECTURE LEAD · BBVA PERU

Enterprise AI strategy · Agentic AI · Banking transformation

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SUMMARY

Enterprise AI & Cloud architecture leader with 15+ years in technology, focused on the financial sector: I define how a regulated bank adopts agentic AI, GenAI platforms, and cloud-native architecture — and get it into production without compromising security or compliance. At BBVA Peru I lead the AI & Cloud architecture strategy, connecting the Group's AI strategy with local execution: part of the Holding team that co-defined the Group's AI Decision Framework and agentic reference architecture in Madrid, and responsible architect for the country's first agentic AI use case in production. Led teams of up to 50 people across three architecture domains, mobilized 100+ more, and ran a Holding-funded core banking program for three years (3x faster time-to-market). Technically hands-on: I keep a self-hosted lab of open-source, production-grade AI infrastructure and trained a GPT-style language model from scratch — own BPE tokenizer, training, and evaluation — on Ricardo Palma's *Tradiciones Peruanas*, so I understand models from the inside, not only through an API.

CORE SKILLS (SELECTED)

ARCHITECTURE	Enterprise Architecture · Core Banking · Cloud-Native & Hybrid Cloud · Microservices · Event-Driven
AI / ML	Agentic AI · Agent Architectures · Generative AI · LLM Inference · LLM Internals & Fine-tuning · AIOps
GOVERNANCE	AI Governance & Regulation · Responsible AI Policy · Build vs. Buy Evaluation · FinOps for AI · Pilot Governance
ENGINEERING	Python · Rust · Java / Spring · .NET · Kubernetes · OpenTelemetry
LEADERSHIP	Technology Strategy · Scrum / Product Ownership · Budget & Capacity Management · Holding Coordination

EXPERIENCE

AI & Enterprise Architecture Lead — BBVA Peru — 2024 – Present

- **Strategy:** define the bank's AI & Cloud architecture strategy, translating the Group's AI strategy into local capabilities, standards, and priorities; presented a mixed large/small-model architecture (cost, latency, and data-sovereignty driven) to the CIO.
- **Group architecture:** 2025 international assignment (PDI Program) with the Holding's AI Architecture team in Madrid — part of the team that co-defined v1 of the Group-wide AI Decision Framework (no-code / low-code / build per use case), presented to the Group's top leadership, and a layered, multi-vendor agentic reference architecture.
- **Industrialization:** responsible architect for the country's first agentic AI use case, now in production, evolving customer servicing in the contact center; led the self-hosted LLM inference platform in the bank's data center for AI-for-ITOps and AI-for-processes pilots.
- **Governance & security:** defined the country's AI pilot governance model together with the Strategy & Control area; every AI initiative passes Security Architecture and Risk review, with guardrails and monitoring required from vendors.
- **Responsible AI:** contributed to the definition of the country's responsible AI policies, aligned with local regulation: customer-facing agents disclose they are AI and generated content is labeled.

Lead Core Banking & Cloud Architect — BBVA Peru — 2019 – 2024

- Product Owner, then Sponsor, of the Horizon Alpha core banking transformation (case study below), run with Scrum; led up to ~50 people (20 internal, 30 external across four consulting firms) spanning Core, APX, and Host architecture, mobilized 100+ more across country and Holding teams, and managed the capacity budget on an FTE-cost basis.
- Started the legacy-to-NextGen transaction migration from 0% (2018) and handed it over at 42% (2022); it reaches 71% in 2026. Transaction volume grew 5x while cost grew 2x (2020–2024).
- Represented engineering on the bank's Innovation Leadership team.

Backend Architecture Manager — BBVA Peru — 2018 – 2019

- Scope expanded to the entire backend: architect responsible for the evolution strategy of the ASO, APX, and Mainframe architectures and the private cloud platform (Ether) in Peru, leading internal and external teams. Taught architecture standards at BBVA's internal Tech University (2018–2020).

APX & Private Cloud Architect — BBVA Peru — 2017 – 2018

- Directed the evolution of the transactional architecture (APX) and the bank's private cloud (Ether); 2018 international assignment to Madrid HQ (see Global Assignments).

Platform as a Service (PaaS) Architect — BBVA Peru — 2016 – 2017

- Led the evolution of the bank's services/API platform (ASO), defined microservices and event-driven standards, and built online and streaming inference so channels consume ML models in real time, not only in batch.

Solutions Architect / IT Architect — Equifax — 2015 – 2016

- Designed architectures for critical projects (Self-Service, Smart SVI, Datamart Financiero) and large-scale data processing pipelines (OSTRA).

Software Technical Lead — CSTI, Softmarkperu, Universidad JFSC 2010 – 2015

- Led multidisciplinary development teams building systems in Java/Spring, PHP, and .NET for healthcare, telecom, and public-sector clients — the hands-on foundation later architecture decisions drew on.

LEADERSHIP CASE STUDY — HORIZON ALPHA

Role: Product Owner → Sponsor **Program:** Horizon Alpha (Holding-funded, >€1M over 3 years) **Where:** BBVA Peru

When: 2019–2024

BBVA Peru needed to evolve its core banking platform to launch new digital products without disrupting critical operations. I led that evolution: 11 of the new Core's 16 reusable capabilities implemented across data, banking-architecture, and multichannel layers, so products are built on top instead of rebuilding customer, consent, or signature management each time.

- Enabled the Retail transformation (access, consents, global position, transaction history in the mobile app) and Business banking processes (mass payroll, multi-signature approvals, business mobile app), implementing the functional core across the bank's technical stacks (ASO, APX, SEMaaS, LRABatch, Cells Web) with the Group's global architecture teams.
- Mobilized 100+ people across the country and the Holding to deploy each Alpha Core release (1,500+ components) in under a quarter with quality automation — the first country in the Group with a zero-impact release.

3x
faster time-to-market: 3–4 quarters → 1–1.5 per product

100%
KPI compliance for rollout and evolution

33%
of the country's strategic initiatives running on the new Core

11/16
reusable core capabilities implemented; ~7 products across Retail and Business

GLOBAL ASSIGNMENTS

2025 · MADRID, SPAIN — INTERNATIONAL PDI PROGRAM

Group AI Architecture team

Joined BBVA Group's holding AI Architecture team to help design the Group's agentic AI architecture: a reference architecture and the Decision Framework for choosing the right technology for each use case.

2018 · MADRID, SPAIN

Microservices & gRPC architecture

Designed the bank's new containerized microservices architecture built on gRPC, deployable on BBVA's hybrid cloud platform, working directly with the Group's global architecture team.

Day to day, coordination with BBVA Group's international architecture teams across Spain, Mexico, Colombia, Argentina, and Turkey.

SPEAKING & RECOGNITION

SEPTEMBER 2026 · LIMA, PERU

C-level panel — Semana Económica

Represented BBVA on a panel for a private club of C-level executives from Peruvian companies, alongside Microsoft and Sonda. Featured in a Semana Económica interview and profile after the event.

JUNE 2026 · LIMA, PERU

Investors Peru Event

Represented BBVA Peru and presented how the bank executes its AI strategy, sharing concrete use cases and best practices with institutional clients.

OPEN-SOURCE LAB — GITHUB.COM/ROOT1V

- **prometheus-inference-platform**
  Self-hosted LLM inference gateway (llama.cpp, MLX, vLLM, SGLang): JWT auth, per-model authorization, OpenTelemetry.
- **mercatus-agentic-payments**
  Agentic commerce framework with x402 (USDC) and AP2 (mandate-based) settlement adapters.
- **veritium-document-intelligence**
  Agentic document intelligence: bounded ReAct extraction, CEL-rule validation, deterministic grounding.
- **aerarium-agentic-banking**
  Rust double-entry ledger where AI agents are first-class account holders (hold-to-capture).
- **synaptum-framework**
  Python agent runtime: checkpoint/resume, deterministic step identity, zero required dependencies.
- **aeon-agent-harness**
  Self-hosted agent harness on Temporal: typed evidence, policy outside the model, governed memory.

CONTINUOUS LEARNING

- **CS50: Artificial Intelligence with Python** — Harvard University
- **Deep Learning** — MIT
- **Deep Learning Specialization** — DeepLearning.AI · Coursera
- **Leadership Program (6 months)** — BBVA Campus, 2024
- **CS221: AI — Principles & Techniques** — Stanford University
- **LLM Agents (MOOC)** — UC Berkeley
- **TOGAF — Enterprise Architecture** — New Horizons
- **Project Management (PMBOK)** — PM Criteria